Welcoming and Supporting Partners Working at a Shelter

Guidance for orienting and engaging direct support from partners at shelters

Typically performed by: *Shelter Site Manager, Shelter Shift Supervisor*
Roles likely to support task: *Shelter Resident Transition, Client Care, HQ Sheltering Manager*

Considerations

- Operational leadership coordinates and approves the assignment of partner organizations to support operations and our clients at Red Cross Managed shelters.
- The needs of clients and the shelter site will influence the types of services and levels of support that partners would provide at shelters.
- Partner organizations that may support shelter operations include animal welfare agencies, county social services, feeding partners, homeless service agencies and children's services.
- The types of activities and support the partner provides influence how much space and equipment they need at the shelter.
- Organizations supporting Red Cross operations must act in ways that align with Red Cross principles and policies and work under the oversight of the Shelter Site Manager.

- Partners access to individual client information must be coordinate with Operational Leadership – as opposed to the shelter staff -- to determine what information will be provided and if an information sharing agreement is needed.
- Related **Shelter Activity Standards**:
    - Shelter Operations

What to do

- Welcome the partner and identify their leader.
- Be sure you understand of their mission and desired approach to supporting clients and/or the shelter operation.
- Provide an orientation to the current operations and activities of the shelter.
- Provide an overview of the client population and identified needs.
- Determine the location where they will work and provide workspace, internet access and other logistical support as appropriate.
- The Shelter Site Manager checks-in daily (or with greater frequency when necessary) to discuss any needs and share information.
- Include partners in daily shelter briefings.
- If another organization arrives at the shelter without the shelter staff receiving notification that they will be coming, immediately contact the HQ Sheltering Manager to discuss how that organization will be supporting shelter operations.

Related Articles

Responding to Conflict and Difficult Client Situations in a Shelter
Guidance for workers in shelters on approaches to addressing challenging situations related to clients

Sheltering Toolkit
Resources for Red Cross workers supporting the sheltering activity during readiness and shelter operations

Questions

For assistance contact **Sheltering@redcross.org**

Welcoming and Supporting Partners Working at a Shelter V1 2026.04.28

Mass Care - Sheltering

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